

"Ridgeline HD 6.7 TD: Worn rear shock absorber causes load-bed sag and ride

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Area: bulletins

1 Condition

Ridgeline HD 6.7 TD vehicles may exhibit a sagging load bed, excessive rebound, and a harsh ride over uneven surfaces, particularly when loaded. The symptom develops gradually as the rear damper loses control of body motion. The affected component is rear shock absorber SHK-8520. System orientation is provided in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Suspension System Overview .

2 Cause

The condition is caused by internal seal wear and fluid loss in rear shock absorber SHK-8520, which reduces damping force and allows the rear axle to oscillate. Vehicles operated under sustained heavy loads or in high-temperature duty cycles are more likely to exhibit accelerated wear. A leaking SHK-8520 will often show oil film on the shock body. Component detail is documented in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Rear Shock Absorber section.

3 Repair Procedure

Replace the affected rear shock absorber SHK-8520 in axle-pair sets following the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Rear Shock Sub-System Service . If the inspection reveals related lower control arm wear, complete procedure PROC-CONTROL-ARM as described in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Control Arm Replacement Procedure . For prior guidance on control-arm-related front clunk and tire wear, see Ridgeline HD: Front clunk and uneven tire wear from worn lower control arm . After replacement, confirm correct ride height and verify ride quality on a loaded road test.